watch him play cricket a few times. I can't tell yet whether he's going to make his career in sport. I guess now that he's turning 14, you can start to see how good he is at a sport. I think once a kid gets to that age, you can form a good picture of how good he'll be. You still can't make a definite call on whether or not he'll make the big time, but you get a feel for what he can accomplish and what sort of levels he can reach.

I haven't seen enough of Rashard's abilities yet, but I know he enjoys his cricket and football. He's going to be tall as well – he already takes a bigger size shoe than me! And he's a good boy … he's got brains, this one.

In personality, I see a lot of similarities between the two of us. I went to his birthday party last year and, like me, he loves to be the life and soul of the party. He definitely likes the attention; it was funny to see. And, just like me, he gets shy and nervous at times too. I can see when he is not entirely confident in a situation. Like me, when I have to make a speech. I don't like standing up and speaking in public at all. I find it completely bladdy nerve-wracking.

My relationship with Liesl is all right these days. Although we don't really talk much, I think she can see that I've made a real effort to stay in touch with Rashard. I don't think it's been easy for him to have me for a father: a public figure *and* one who doesn't see him that often. Kids at his primary school used to hassle him for being my son, which I think bothered him, because he got into a bit of kak every now and again. These days he's at St John's and he's made some good friends there. He's doing okay now.

I still help him financially, but the amount varies from month to month. I contribute to his school fees, for example, and sometimes Liesl and I split the costs. I make a point of not spoiling Rashard, because I wasn't really ever spoilt as a child, and I don't believe kids should get stuff just because they want it. But now I can't give him my old Puma shoes any more, as his feet have grown too big!

I am grateful to Liesl for having raised him the way she did. He has been well looked after and he's happy and healthy.

So that's fatherhood and me. It started off shaky, but the future looks bright. Of course, I can say the exact opposite about my marriage …

Marriage

I first met Tenielle Povey at the legendary Billy the Bums bar in Durban during the 2003 World Cup, where I was hanging out with my teammates